



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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December 27, 2025

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Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRPsystem and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together

for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

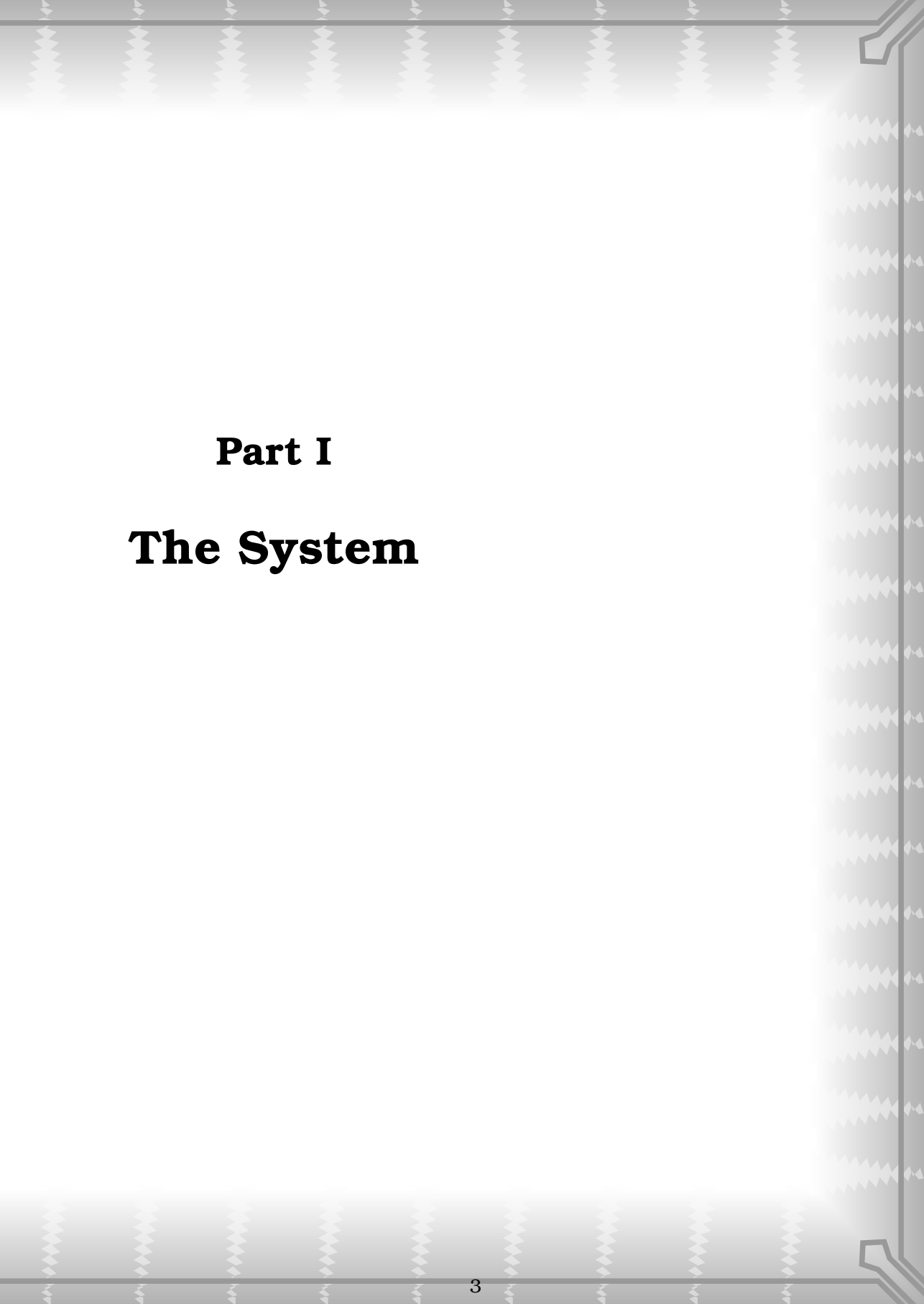
I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

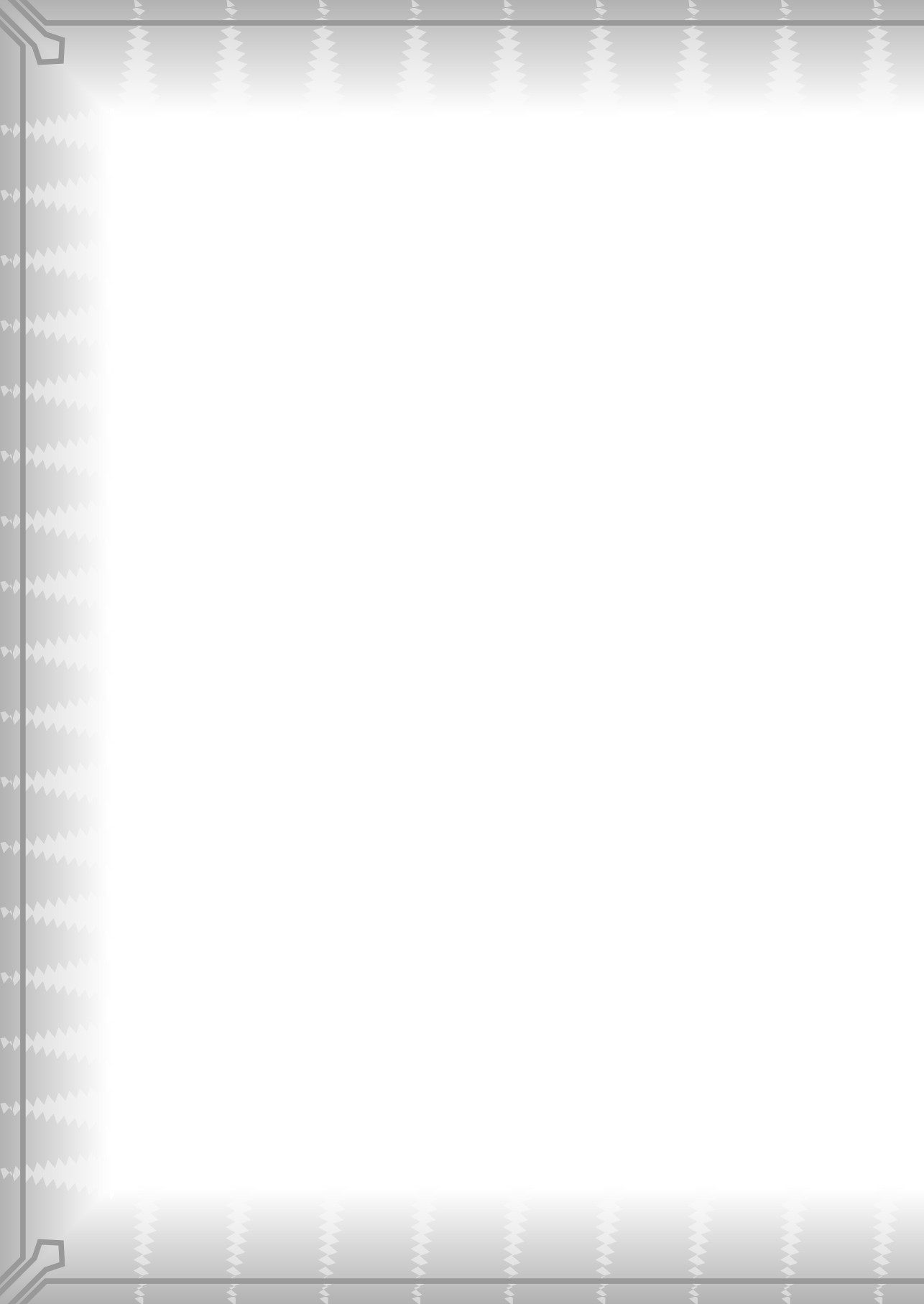
Gamma RP, or ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator

RXaY RXa0 R3aY



Part I

The System



2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character—a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.

The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain at least a dozen 12 sided dice for convenience. It is possible to play with fewer dice by rolling one die at a time.

2.1 Dice Rolling Basics

The notation for a roll in TRP is written as $RXaY$, which verbally is pronounced as "Roll X a Y"

X is the number of dice you roll.

Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top Y numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success. This means that both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.

Let's look at a few example rolls.

Table 2.1a: Advantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R5a1	① ① ⑧ ④ ⑩	FAILURE
R5a1	① ① ② ⑫ ②	SUCCESS
R4a1	① ① ⑧ ⑩	FAILURE
R4a2	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R4a3	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R3a3	① ⑨ ⑧	FAILURE
R3a4	① ⑨ ⑧	SUCCESS
R3a8	② ④ ③	FAILURE
R3a9	② ④ ③	SUCCESS

The quickest way to judge if your advantaged roll is a success is:

1. Add the advantage to the value of each die in your roll
2. If $[ADVANTAGE] + [DIE\ VALUE] > 12$ for any die in your roll, your roll is a success.

An advantage of 0 is the exception to this

method: $RXa0$ is still successful if any of the dice roll a 12.

Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvantage* which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $RXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $RXdZ$.

For a roll at *disadvantage* of Z to be successful, in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least Z dice within the roll displaying a number above 1.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2.1b: Disadvantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
$R2d1$	 	SUCCESS
$R2d1$	 	SUCCESS
$R2d2$	 	FAILURE
$R4d1$	   	FAILURE
$R4d2$	   	SUCCESS
$R4d3$	   	SUCCESS
$R4d4$	   	FAILURE
$R8d7$	       	FAILURE

The quickest way to judge if your disadvantaged roll is a success is:

1. Check if there are any dice showing 12 in your roll
2. Count the number of dice that show a value above 1
3. If $[NUMBER\ OF\ DICE\ ABOVE\ 1] > [DISADVANTAGE]$ for *any* die in your roll, and there is at least one die showing 12, your roll is a success.

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. This is because you do not have sufficient number of dice to show . Additionally, any roll with a disadvantage 12 or greater automatically fails, for symmetry with the advantage rolls (where any roll with an advantage 12 or greater automatically succeeds) If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice (or make a roll with a disadvantage greater than 12), you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Note that the rolls $RXa1$, $RXa0$, and $RXd1$ are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

Table 2.1c: Probability of success for various rolls

$RXaY$	$RXd6$	$RXd5$	$RXd4$	$RXd3$	$RXd2$	$RXd1$	$RXa0$	$RXa1$	$RXa2$	$RXa3$	$RXa4$	$RXa5$	$RXa6$	$RXa7$
$R1aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	8.3%	8.3%	16.7%	25.0%	33.3%	41.7%	50.0%	58.3%
$R2aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.3%	16.0%	16.0%	16.0%	30.6%	43.8%	55.6%	66.0%	75.0%	82.6%
$R3aY$	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.4%	21.6%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	42.1%	57.8%	70.4%	80.2%	87.5%	92.8%
$R4aY$	0.0%	0.0%	24.0%	25.7%	27.5%	29.4%	29.4%	29.4%	51.8%	68.4%	80.2%	88.4%	93.8%	97.0%
$R5aY$	0.0%	26.4%	28.4%	30.5%	32.8%	35.3%	35.3%	35.3%	59.8%	76.3%	86.8%	93.2%	96.9%	98.7%
$R6aY$	27.9%	30.1%	32.5%	35.0%	37.7%	40.7%	40.7%	40.7%	66.5%	82.2%	91.2%	96.1%	98.4%	99.5%

2.2 Modifying Rolls

Very often a character will have a default way they roll something in a situation, but the circumstances of the situation impair or improve their chances of success.

When this happens, it is often easier as a GM to specify the roll they must make as a modification of their usual roll.

There are two ways to modify a roll- you can modify the number of dice a character has, or you can modify the advantage they have on the roll.

2.2.1 Bonus and Penalty Dice

In general, you should only modify the number of dice a character has for a roll if the rulebook specifies that you should do so. Modifying the number of dice is described using the terms “die bonus” and “die penalty”.

If the rules specify you take a *W* die penalty- then you roll with *W* fewer dice than you ordinarily would.

If the rules specify you take a *X* die bonus- then you roll with *X* more dice than you ordinarily would.

2.2.2 Additional Advantage and Disadvantage

Modifying the advantage and disadvantage on a roll may be done more freely by the GM. If the situation is harder than usual, the GM may impose “additional disadvantage” on the players. If the situation has been modified to be easier than usual, the GM may grant “additional advantage” to the players.

If the GM or the rules specify you take *Y* additional advantage- then you roll with *Y* higher advantage than you ordinarily would.

If the GM or the rules specify you take *Z* additional disadvantage- then you roll with *Z* lower advantage than you ordinarily would. Remember that in the roll no-

tation -*Z* advantage is the same as *Z* disadvantage. Rolling with additional disadvantage will not often make the absolute roll a disadvantaged roll, there will still be some net advantage to the roll left over after applying some minor additional disadvantage.

2.3 Group Rolls

Sometimes you may want multiple characters all contribute effort to determine if they succeed at a task. You can do this with a group roll.

The process of a group roll is as follows:

1. Each character making a group roll makes the corresponding roll for the task
2. Count the total number of successes among the group
3. If $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] \geq [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ then the group succeeds at the roll.

If you need to count the number of successes for a group roll, it is $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}]/[\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ rounded **down** to the nearest whole number.

This may be most easily illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the swamp, the mud grows deeper and harder to trudge through. You'll all have to use your athletics talent to pass without hurting yourselves.

Alice: Can we make this a group roll? I think we could help each other cross.

GM: Absolutely. Make a group roll for athletics.

ATHLETICS GROUP ROLL

Bob: R3a3 - ⑧ ⑧ ③
(continued...)

(...continued)

Alice: R5a5 - ③ ⑧ ② ③ ⑩**Eve:** R6a4 - ③ ⑧ ⑫ ③ ① ②**GM:** Great. Between all of you you have 3 successes. Alice's extra success makes up for Bob's lack of success.

Bob- you stumble in the thick mud and almost land face first, but Alice catches you. You all struggle through and make it through the swamp without injury.

2.4 Roll Contests

Sometimes, one character may be asked to dynamically struggle against the abilities of another character or entity within the game. When this happens, the game enters a roll contest- where both characters roll against each other and apply penalties to the other's roll depending on how well they do.

The process of a roll contest is as follows:

1. Both characters make their roll simultaneously.
2. If one character is successful and the other is not, the successful character wins.
3. If both characters are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both characters are successful, the first character will be penalized dice equal to the number of successes of the second character, and vice versa. Return to step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one character has no

dice remaining, the character who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both characters reach 0 dice simultaneously, both characters lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

If there are no penalties for losing the contest, a simultaneous fail just ends the contest with no effect. Step 6 is only important when one of the characters has an ability that imposes a penalty for failing a roll.

Roll Contests are probably best illustrated with an example as follows.

Eve: Can I initiate a grapple on the guard?**GM:** Sure! Go ahead and initiate a Roll Contest with Dexterity.**Eve:** I'll roll with Athletics since I'm better at that.**GM:** Sure, you can *talent proxy*. Use Athletics at 2 additional disadvantage.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 1

Eve: R6a2 - ③ ⑤ ⑨ ① ④ ⑤**Guard:** R4a4 - ② ⑧ ③ ②**Eve:** Shoot.**GM:** Don't worry, neither of you have any successes, so you'll roll again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 2

Eve: R6a2 - ⑨ ⑪ ⑦ ② ⑥ ③**Guard:** R4a4 - ⑨ ① ③ ⑩

GM: You grab the guard but he's wriggling out of your grasp. You'll roll with 2 fewer dice since he got 2 successes, and he'll roll with 1 fewer dice because you got 1 success. Go again.
(continued...)

(...continued)
ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 3

Eve: R4a2 - 12 4 1 2

Guard: R3a4 - 4 7 3

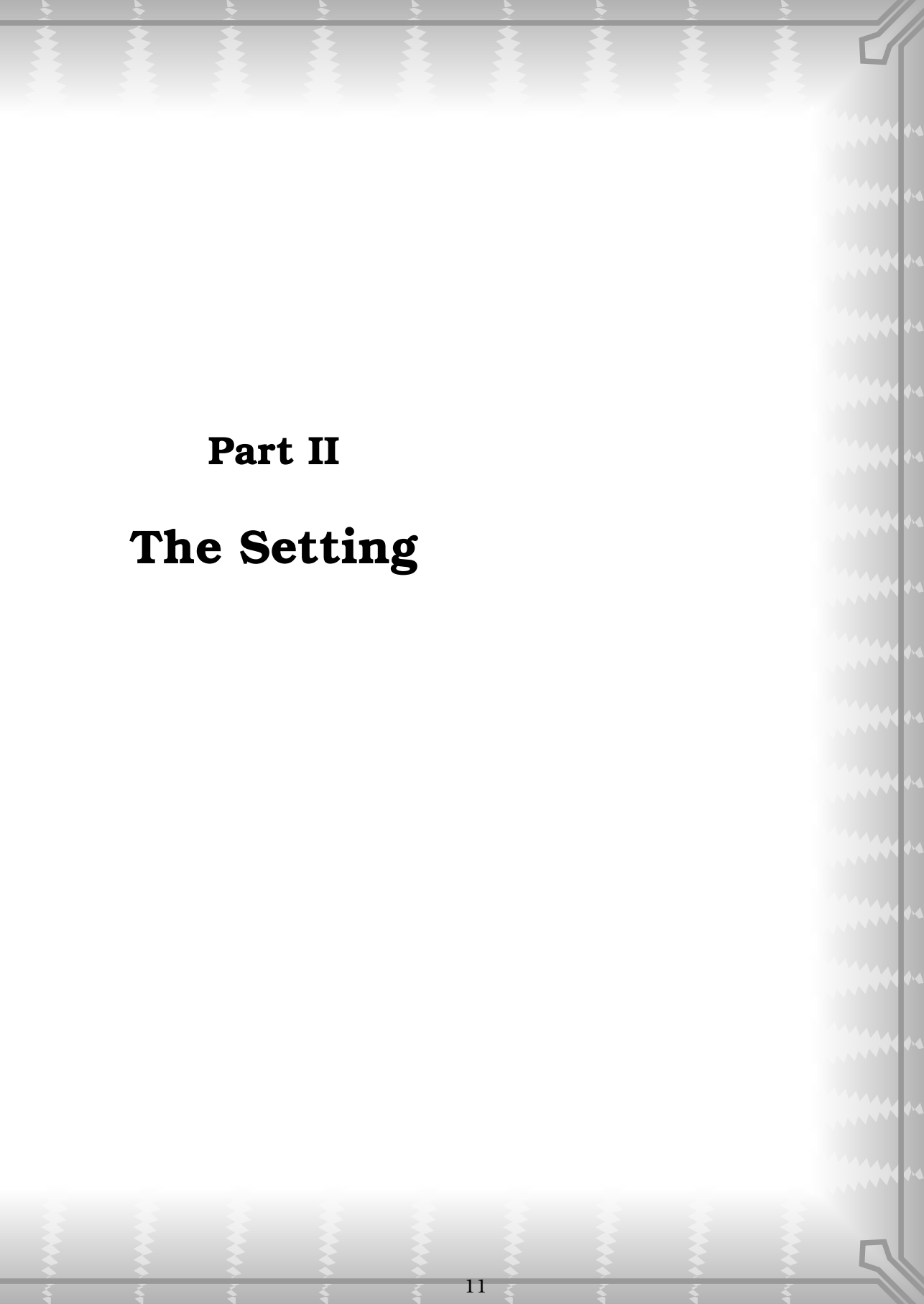
Eve: Yes! I succeeded and the guard did not.

GM: Great! You deftly bend the guard's arm and twist him into your awaiting chokehold. You've grappled the guard.

It is highly disrecommended to perform a *group roll contest*. For tasks of that complexity it is usually better to let the game enter phased mode- which will be described in detail later.

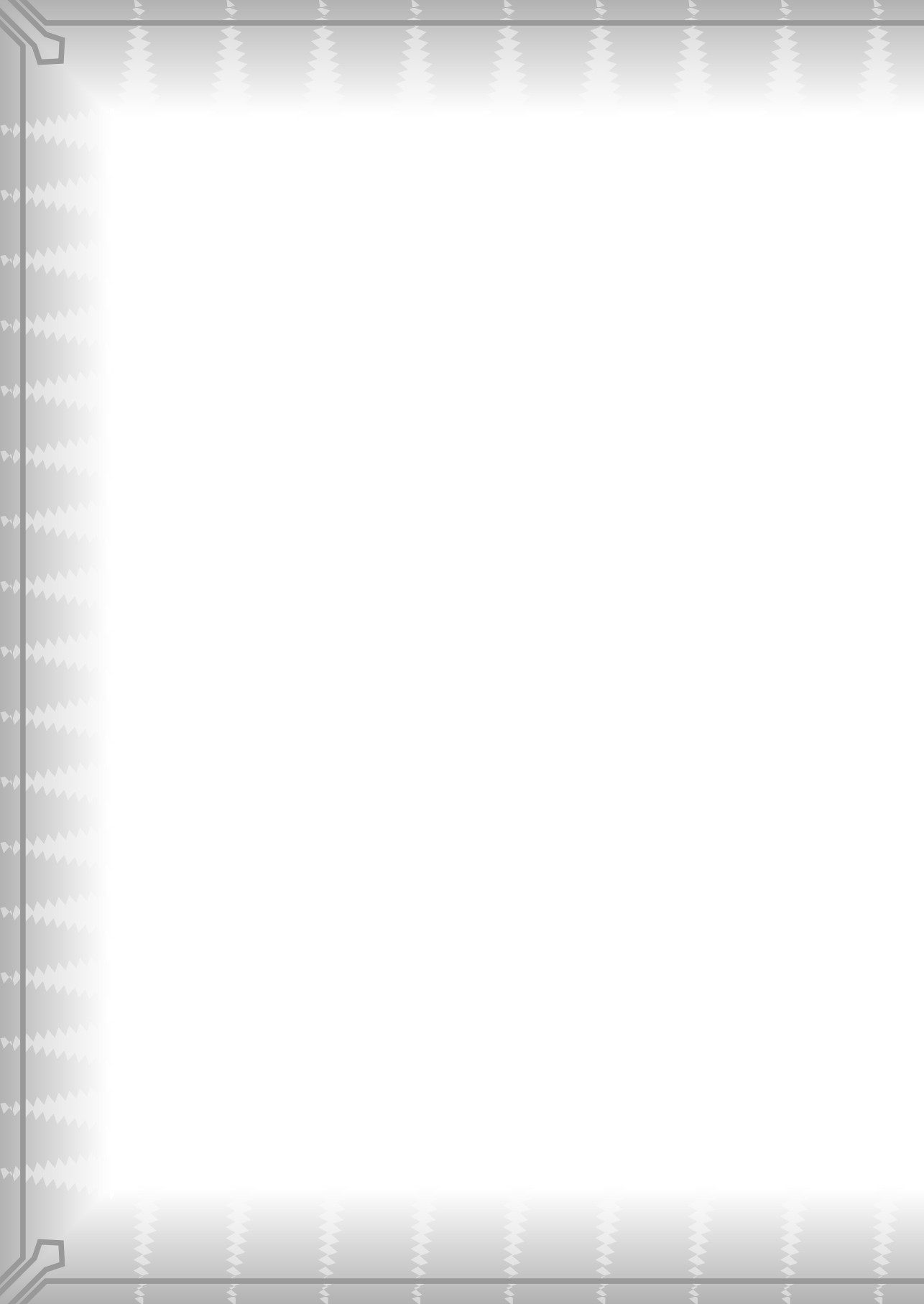
If you do find yourself in a situation in which a group roll contest is called for, the process is as follows.

1. Both groups make their group rolls simultaneously..
2. If one group is successful and the other is not, the successful group wins.
3. If both groups are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both groups are successful, the first group must be penalized a number of dice equal to the second group's number of successes, and vice versa. Every character in the group takes this penalty. Then return to Step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one group has no dice remaining, the group who has dice remaining wins the contest.
6. If both groups reach 0 dice simultaneously, both groups lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).



Part II

The Setting



Overview of the Gamma Nebula

Gamma Nebula is a futuristic setting in another universe where advanced magic has enabled space exploration. The physics and the rules of the Gamma Nebula universe are very different to our own. Gamma Nebula has its own cosmology, history, and cultures, but a Game Master using the setting is encouraged to invent their own.

This book will lay out a framework of the galaxy and the way it works, but the details are left up to the Game Master and players, who may improvisationally create planets and peoples.

It's a big galaxy out there, with surprises and mysteries both ancient and new.

3.1 A brief history

The Gamma Nebula setting takes place in a galaxy called the Great Spiral. There are currently approximately 100 known inhabited worlds in the great spiral governed by the Galactic Alliance, and linked through Fey Space by Fey Corridors.

More than 100,000 years ago, an event called The Great Collapse occurred that formed the universe. Scholars theorize that prior to this event, many of the planes that are currently wrapped into small dimensions used to be as accessible as the material plane, and that the universe was a much bigger place previously, though it may have been inhospitable to existence as we know it. The general consensus from both high level clerics and ancient artifacts obtained from Pla-

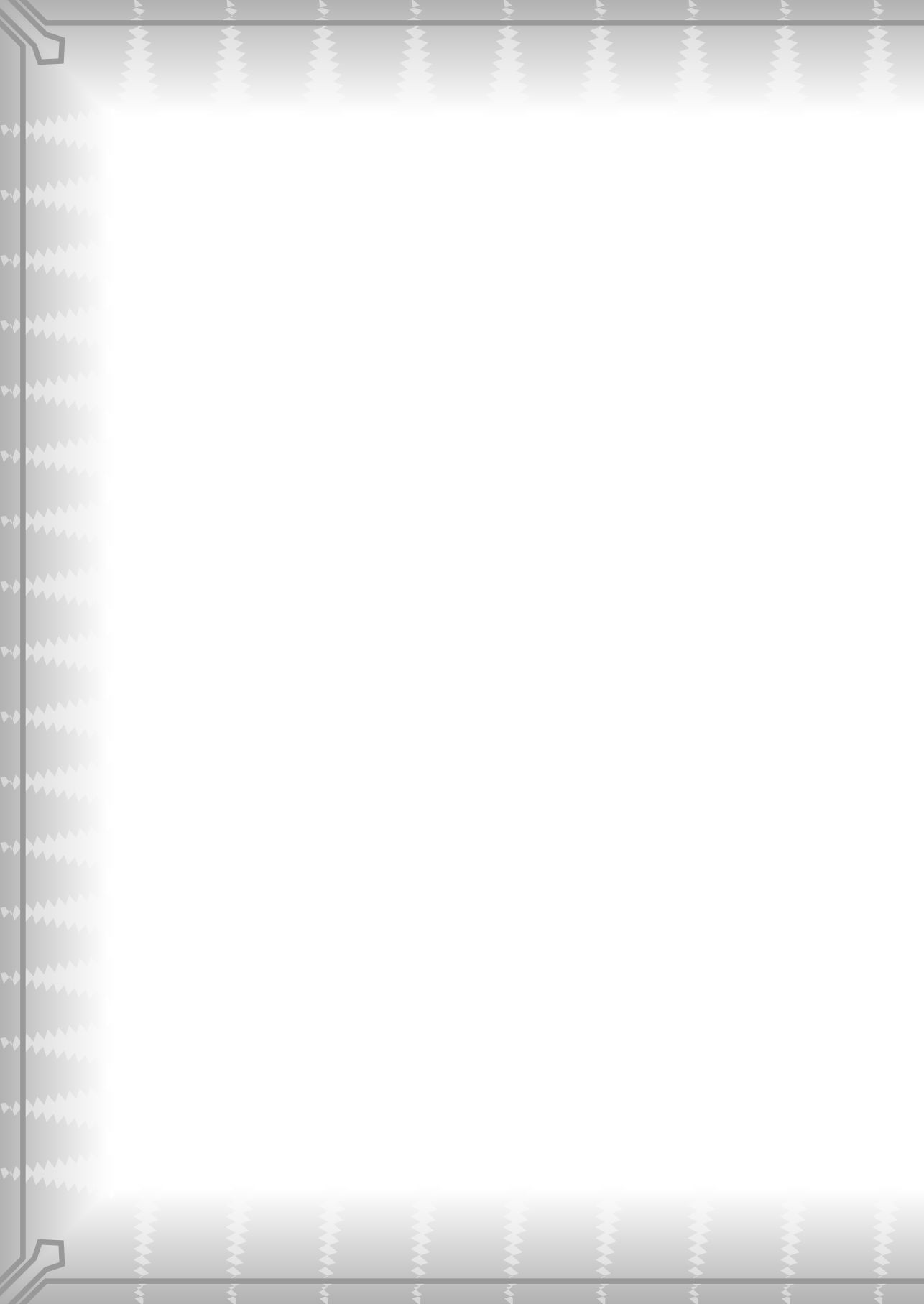
nar Pockets is that The Gods had something to do with this, and that The Great Collapse and the creation of this universe was an attempt to prevent a great force of destruction from overcoming them and the life that came before.

Within the first 10000 years after The Great Collapse the dragons built the Fey Corridor network. A flourishing galactic civilization of more than 2000 worlds was formed with numerous species using the network for communication and trade. The vast majority of the details of this civilization were lost during the Spiral War 40,000 years ago. All Fey Corridors were unusable for the first 1000 years after the Spiral War, and many Fey Corridor openings were completely destroyed or became permanently inoperable. Vast amounts of knowledge and technology were lost during that time. The technology used to create the Fey Corridors is slowly being rediscovered and some Fey Corridors are being restored. Unfortunately not all Fey Corridors can be restored because both ends of a Fey Corridor must be restored. For many known Fey Corridor openings, the location of another linked opening is not known and thus a viable corridor cannot be established. There are an estimated 1000 Fey Corridors that could be restored if the other opening could be physically accessed and repaired. These nonfunctioning fey corridors are said to lead to Lost Worlds, which may very well harbor life and a society disconnected from the Galactic Alliance. There have been 3 Lost Worlds which have had a civilization which restored their side of a Fey Corri-

dor Opening and rejoined the Galactic Alliance. All others have been restored from the side of the burgeoning Galactic Alliance.

Part III

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